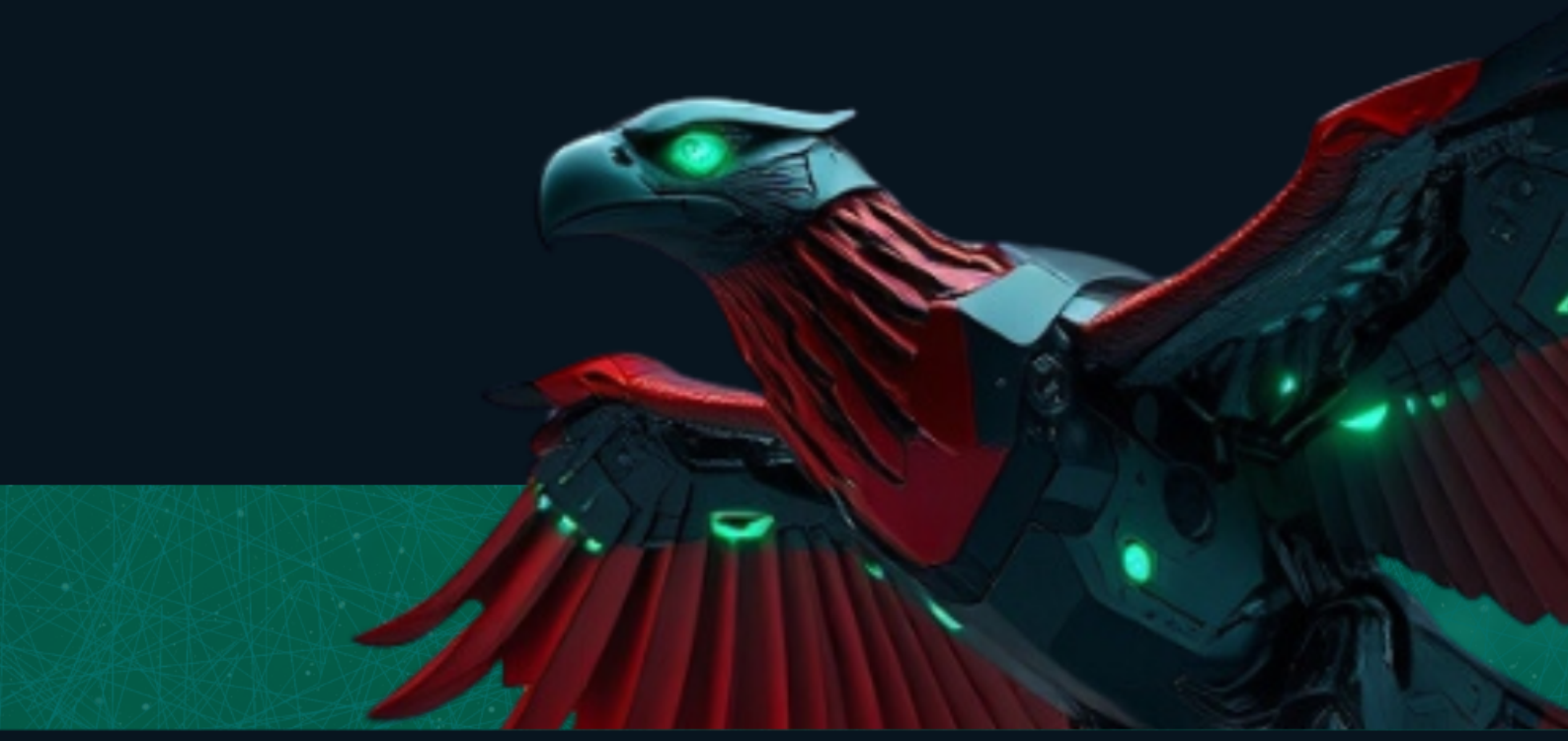
SOCBYTE
ALL BYTES SECURED

# CASE REPORT



# Case Details

| | |
|---|---|
| **Reference ID** | CTHTY-222 |
| **Title** | Attempt to dump the memory of the Local Security Authority Subsystem Service to extract hashed or plaintext credentials. |
| **Status** | Closed |
| **Severity** | High |
| **Tactics** | Credential Access |
| **Created By** | christopher.mirro@thevsoc.com |
| **Created At** | Jul 08, 2026, 08:51 PM |
| **Category** | Stealth |
| **Sub-Category** | Masquerading |
| **Tenant** | Cythority |
| **Age** | 5 minutes |
| **Offense ID** | — |

# Groups & Contributors

## Assigned Groups

SOC-Cythority

## Contributors

christopher.mirro@thevsoc.com

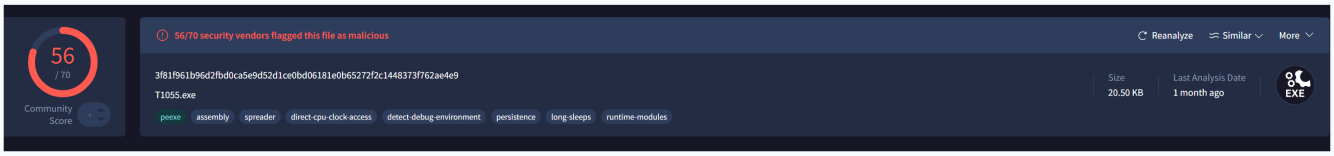
# Analysis Summary

On 2026-04-19 at 23:53:10 UTC, Cythrority's VSOC investigated a critical alert on CrowdStrike. This alert represents a definitive, malicious true positive for an active OS Credential Dumping attempt targeting the workstation DESKTOP-EED8T69. Rather than deploying easily detectable malware binaries, the adversary executed a textbook "Living off the Land" technique by spawning powershell.exe to leverage a trusted system utility, rundll32.exe. This binary was weaponized to proxy a native Windows deployment function, comsvcs.dll MiniDump, passing the exact Process ID (60) of the Local Security Authority Subsystem Service (lsass.exe) to dump its raw memory contents. The technical indicators conclusively rule out an administrative false positive; while administrators occasionally collect process dumps for diagnostic purposes, they do not use masqueraded naming conventions like svchost-exe.dmp inside a hidden user path (AppData\Local\Temp), nor do they run these calls through interactive PowerShell loops.

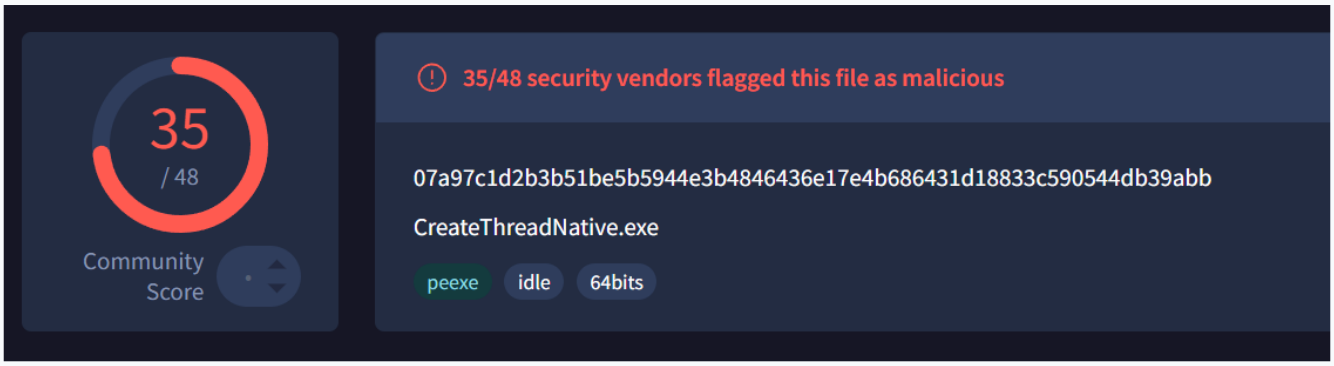
94cae63dcbabb71c5dd43f55fd09caeffdcd7628a02a112fb3cba36698ef72bc- gsecdump. From an architectural standpoint, the potential blast radius of an unmitigated attack of this nature is critical. Because lsass.exe serves as the central repository for active interactive login sessions, NTLM hashes, and Kerberos tickets, a successful compromise allows an adversary to entirely bypass standard authentication controls. With these harvested credentials, an attacker can escalate privileges, map out internal file shares, and move laterally to critical servers or Active Directory environments without triggering signature-based alerts. This tactical behavior represents standard pre-ransomware tradecraft, typically serving as the final staging phase before initiating mass data exfiltration or full network deployment.

When mapping this sequence to the MITRE ATT&CK framework for technical tracking, the adversary executed a highly distinct progression of techniques. The initial execution vector relied on Command and Scripting Interpreter: PowerShell (T1059.001) to launch the command string. For defense evasion, they weaponized System Binary Proxy Execution: Rundll32 (T1218.011), masquerading malicious activity behind a trusted OS process. This directly supported the final objective: OS Credential Dumping: LSASS Memory (T1003.001) via the mini-dump API. Although the endpoint protection platform intervened to enforce a File quarantined action and the host's current *Offline* status temporarily pauses the active threat, keeping network containment queued ensures immediate isolation the moment the asset re-establishes a connection.

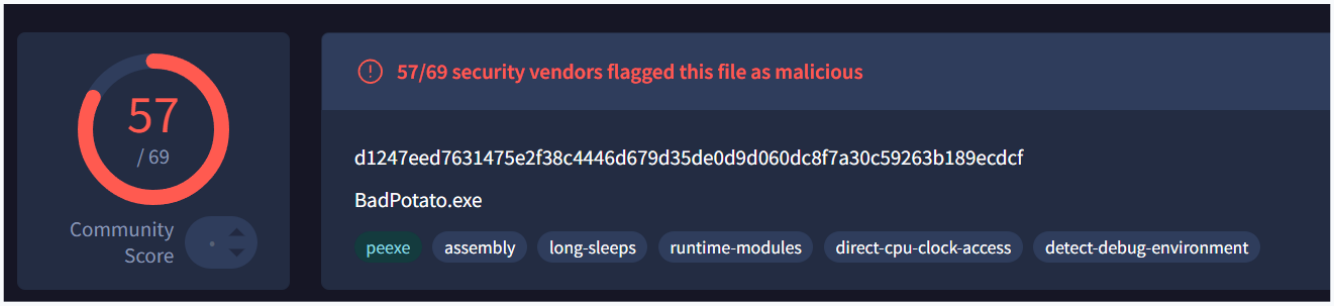
# Evidence



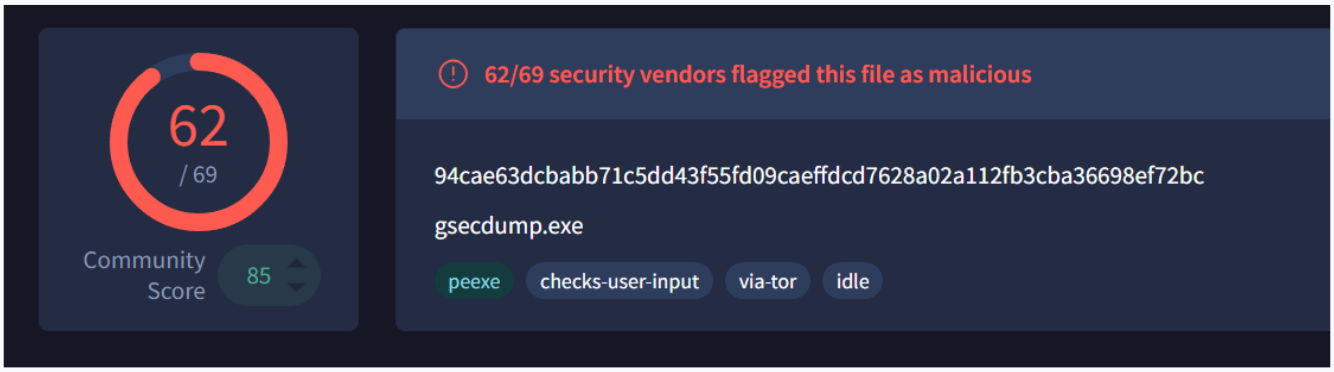

Evidence 1




Evidence 2




Evidence 3




Evidence 4

## Remediation

- Enforce Network Containment Immediately
- Revoke and Reset Compromised Credentials
- Investigate Upstream Execution (Parent Process)
- Inspect for Secondary Persistence
- Validate Quarantine and Run Forensic Scans